

Workshop on Anonymous Browsing

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Anonymous browsing is the process of browsing the internet while keeping any personally identifiable information secret. With the help of the IP address, the physical location of your computer can be determined, indirectly leading to the revelation of your identity.

When you browse without anonymous browsing tools

observer is unable to track from the source to the user. There are two basic methods to browse anonymously. These are

1. Web based proxy services such as <https://www.snoopblocker.com>.
2. VPN and proxy clients such as Tor and Hotspot shield.

A web based proxy service such as <https://www.snoopblocker.com> works by having a web server as an intermediary between a user and a web server. Users are

on 'surf!' to visit the webpage. Also, there are several fields that you check or uncheck depending on your needs.

• **Java:** Checking this enables web deployed Java-based applications such as Java applets, programmes such as stock tickers or even new Gmail and Hotmail versions to run through snoopblock. However, these programmes can gather significant information and hence compromise on your anonymity.

• **Javascript:** Javascript is required to run most modern web pages. The drawbacks of enabling this are similar to that of enabling Java.

• **Cookies:** Cookies enable the webpage to perform certain essential web-based functions such as keeping the user signed in at all times and remembering his browsing record. However,

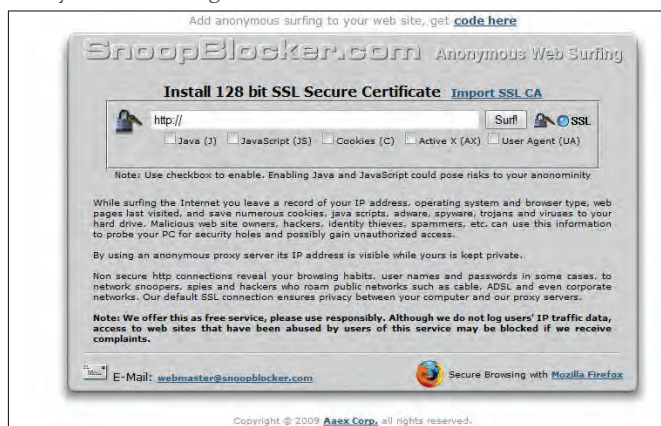
some malicious web sites post cookies known as tracking cookies, which gather information about your activities.

• **Active X :** Allows Microsoft active X content to be displayed. Poses no major threats to anonymity but may slow down the loading process due to higher bandwidth requirements.

After ticking the required options, entering the required address and clicking the 'surf!' button, the requested page is

displayed. However, you will notice that to each webpage, snoopblock.com adds a frame on top with advertisements on it.

The second popular method for browsing the internet anonymously is the usage of virtual private network clients such as Tor, Java Anon Proxy and Hotspot shield. We will look at how to install Tor, which is available for



Google through snoopblocker

through a standard internet service provider, your computer is identified via an IP address, and sends out a request to the server on which the web page is served. The basic principle behind all anonymous browsing tools is the routing of communications through a third server that is committed to protecting the identities of the end user. Hence, anonymous browsing is basically the art of routing web page requests and other packet information over the internet over various lines so that an external

connected over a secure 128 bit SSL connection.

On [snoopblocker.com](https://www.snoopblocker.com), the central field is where you should type the address of the web site you wish to browse. After this has been done, click



Vidalia comes with added flexibility

download from www.torproject.org as a 10-MB file. The bundle contains four components, namely Tor, Vidalia, Privoxy and Torbutton.

Tor is the basic tool that helps in setting up a VPN node on your computer so that you may connect to other users of Tor for anonymous browsing. Tor being a command line tool, it is supplied with Vidalia, a Graphic User Interface utility that allows you to quickly and easily set up Tor and get it running.

Privoxy is a filtering tool that monitors every web page and other internet service